Gmail

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URGENT COMPLAINT — COMMONWEALTH BANK, CALL ME IMMEDIATELY. I NEED ACCESS TO MY OWN MONEY.

Rich McLean <richarddrawsstuff@gmail.com> Wed, 28 Oct at 6:12 pm
To: Mobile Experience Squad Mailbox <MobileExperience@cba.com.au>

Dear Customer Relations Team,

Thank you for your response. However, I must be frank: being asked to repeat procedures that I have already exhausted, without any acknowledgment of the practical barriers preventing me from accessing your services, feels like another layer of bureaucracy rather than meaningful assistance.

This is an urgent banking-access, unresolved-complaint and financial-hardship matter, not simply a routine identity-verification enquiry.

I have already attended Commonwealth Bank branches in Bateau Bay, New South Wales, on multiple occasions seeking assistance. I also attended a Commonwealth Bank branch in **Goulburn, New South Wales**, during a period when I had been transferred to another town in connection with my imprisonment. I have a brain injury that affects my ability to recall certain details, including dates and locations, but I clearly remember attending the Goulburn branch to seek an answer to my complaint.

At Goulburn, I did not receive the substantive resolution I was seeking. I recall the bank manager telling me that he could not do anything and that his hands were tied. I ask Commonwealth Bank to investigate that interaction, establish what records exist of my visit and complaint, and explain why the matter was not resolved or escalated to someone with the authority to address it.

These visits matter because they demonstrate that I have not simply failed to follow the bank's procedures. I have repeatedly attempted to obtain assistance in person, including at two different locations, and I remain without satisfactory answers.

I currently understand that arrangements involving the NSW Public Guardian have resulted in my being unable to access the Commonwealth Bank website and mobile banking application. I also do not have reliable access to a mobile phone or a telephone number through which I can be contacted.

Consequently, directing me to call 13 22 21, use the in-app messaging service or log into NetBank does not resolve the problem. These are precisely the channels I cannot reliably access. I have already attended the bank in person repeatedly, and I need your organisation to identify a workable alternative rather than refer me back to channels that are unavailable to me.

Please escalate this complaint and explain how your Cyber Crime division or another appropriately authorised team can verify my identity and contact me without requiring access to the very services that are currently unavailable to me. Please also confirm whether a case manager can be assigned and how that person will communicate with me.

I have been a Commonwealth Bank customer for more than 45 years. At various points, I have held substantial sums of money in accounts with your institution. The present circumstances are causing me profound distress because I cannot reliably access the banking facilities I need to manage my daily life.

My situation is particularly serious because I am experiencing significant financial hardship and have described difficulties obtaining food, medication, medical care and telephone access. I have also reported concerns about abuse, neglect and my personal safety. I need these circumstances to be treated as an urgent humanitarian concern, not reduced to another procedural exchange.

1. Access to my banking facilities and the role of the NSW Public Guardian

Please explain, in writing, the basis on which my access to NetBank, the mobile banking application and other banking facilities has been restricted; what authority or instruction the bank relied upon; what restrictions are currently in effect; and what process is available for reviewing them.

I need a clear distinction between any legal or administrative arrangement affecting my accounts and the bank's own decisions about the banking services available to me.

I am not asking Commonwealth Bank to disregard a lawful order or arrangement. I am asking the bank to explain the restrictions, establish the scope of its obligations and identify every lawful avenue available to restore appropriate access or provide an alternative means of obtaining essential banking assistance.

I also ask the bank to explain what steps, if any, were taken to assess the practical consequences of these restrictions for my ability to obtain food, medication, medical care and other necessities.

Being unable to access my banking facilities while experiencing severe financial hardship leaves me in an exceptionally vulnerable position. Whatever legal or administrative arrangements apply, I need a clear explanation of my rights, the bank's responsibilities and the options available to me.

2. My unresolved complaints at Bateau Bay and Goulburn

My repeated visits to Bateau Bay and my previous visit to Goulburn must be considered together.

At both locations, I was seeking meaningful assistance with banking matters that I considered serious. At Goulburn, I recall the manager saying that his hands were tied and that he could not do anything. I left without the substantive answer I had sought.

I need Commonwealth Bank to establish what complaints were recorded during these interactions, what decisions were made, whether the matters were escalated, and why I was not provided with a satisfactory written outcome.

If the branch managers lacked the authority to resolve the matter, that should have resulted in a clear explanation of the responsible department and an effective referral process. It should not have left me repeatedly approaching different people without a resolution.

Please search the bank's available records for my branch visits, complaints, referrals and relevant communications. If records cannot be located, explain what searches were conducted and what limitations apply.

My brain injury is also relevant to how this matter should be handled. I may not be able to reconstruct every date or detail from memory, and I should not be required to do so when the bank may hold relevant records of its own interactions with me. Please use the information available in your systems to help establish the history.

3. My unresolved complaint concerning financial transactions and historical records

I have previously raised concerns about financial dealings involving my former partner, Steve Iasonidis, and myself. I have sought access to historical banking information and an explanation of the transactions and records relevant to those concerns.

I have been told that certain information is inaccessible because it relates to a period more than seven years ago. I do not accept a general statement that records are unavailable as a sufficient response to the questions I have raised.

I request a written explanation identifying:

- Which records have been searched for.
- Which records remain available.
- Which records cannot be retrieved, if any.
- The applicable retention or access limitations.
- The reasons for any refusal to provide information.
- Whether any alternative records, statements, transaction histories or other documentation can assist.
- The available review or complaint process if particular records cannot lawfully be disclosed to me.

I am also seeking a substantive written outcome to the financial concerns I have previously reported, including the matters I have described in connection with **123 registered businesses** appearing on a website associated with my allegations.

I understand that these concerns require examination rather than assumption. I am asking Commonwealth Bank to tell me what specific matters it has investigated, what findings it can disclose, and what further information or formal process is required to progress the complaint.

I am not asking the bank to declare that fraud has occurred without investigating the evidence. I am asking it to address the concerns I have reported, explain what it has actually examined and provide a documented outcome rather than leaving me without an answer.

4. The impact of repeated dismissal and what I regard as gaslighting

I need Commonwealth Bank to understand the cumulative human impact of this experience.

I have repeatedly sought answers about matters that I consider extremely serious. I have attended branches, approached staff, raised complaints and attempted to obtain historical financial information. Yet I continue to experience the process as one in which my concerns are met with statements that nothing can be done, that information is unavailable or that I must approach another person or use a channel I cannot access.

When a person repeatedly seeks an explanation and receives no substantive resolution, the resulting distress can become overwhelming. When that person also has a brain injury, limited access to money, difficulties obtaining essential care and no reliable means of telephone communication, the impact is even more serious.

I experienced the repeated dismissal of my concerns as **gaslighting**: a situation in which I felt that the reality of my experience was being denied while I was repeatedly told that no answer, remedy or further action was available. I felt increasingly powerless and distressed because I could not obtain a meaningful explanation of what had happened or why my concerns were not being resolved.

I also recall becoming upset during an interaction at the bank and being threatened with security removing me from the premises. I ask Commonwealth Bank to investigate the circumstances of that interaction, including what preceded it, what I said, what staff said to me and why security was raised as a possibility.

I want the bank to consider the full sequence of events rather than isolate my emotional reaction from the circumstances that preceded it.

A customer's distress does not, by itself, establish that their allegations are correct; equally, a customer's distress does not establish that their allegations are false or justify dismissing them without examination.

If I became upset after repeated unsuccessful attempts to obtain answers, that reaction must be considered in context. I should not have to remain endlessly patient while my substantive concerns remain unresolved, nor should an emotional response become a reason to avoid investigating the underlying complaint.

The pattern I have experienced resembles what is commonly described as a cycle of invalidation: a person raises a concern, receives no satisfactory answer, tries again, becomes increasingly distressed and then finds that their distress becomes the focus instead of the original issue.

I regard this as profoundly unfair. I am asking Commonwealth Bank to break that cycle by examining the actual banking issues, documenting its findings and communicating with me in a manner that recognises my circumstances.

5. My concerns about serious financial wrongdoing and personal safety

My concerns extend beyond the immediate banking restrictions. I have reported what I believe to be serious financial wrongdoing, mistreatment, exploitation and institutional failures. I have also expressed fears for my personal safety and concerns that I am being erased or deliberately deprived of the ability to obtain help.

I recognise that these are serious allegations that require evidence-based examination. I am asking Commonwealth Bank to distinguish between matters established by its own records, matters that require further investigation and matters that fall outside its responsibility.

I am not asking the bank to accept every allegation without scrutiny. I am asking it not to dismiss my reports merely because they are distressing, complex or involve other parties.

My specific request is for Commonwealth Bank to investigate matters within its control, provide the banking information I am lawfully entitled to receive, explain any restrictions and tell me what further avenues are available.

If the bank identifies information suggesting that a matter should be referred to a specialist team or an appropriate external authority, I ask that it explain the relevant process and record the referral where appropriate.

6. My longstanding relationship with Commonwealth Bank

I have been a Commonwealth Bank customer for more than 45 years. I have trusted this institution with my money over decades, including periods when I held hundreds of thousands of dollars in accounts.

That history makes the current situation particularly painful. I feel that I have been left without meaningful access to my bank at a time when I urgently need assistance.

I am deeply concerned that the restrictions affecting me have been imposed or maintained without adequate consideration of their consequences for my independence, dignity and ability to manage my affairs.

I also have concerns that repeated referrals and unanswered complaints are protecting no one except the process itself. I cannot establish the motives behind each decision, and I am not asking the bank to accept my interpretation of those motives as a finding. I am asking for transparent explanations, accountable decisions and a genuine opportunity to have the substantive matters examined.

My longstanding relationship with Commonwealth Bank deserves a response proportionate to the seriousness of the situation I have described.

7. My previous complaints and the need for accountable escalation

I am deeply concerned that repeated referrals and requests for information already supplied are preventing my concerns from reaching someone with the authority to address them.

I have approached the bank in good faith and have repeatedly attempted to obtain assistance. I need a complaint reference, an identifiable responsible team, a clear statement of the outstanding issues and a written explanation of the next steps.

I do not want another response that merely redirects me to a telephone number, an inaccessible application or a website I cannot use.

I have also supplied my website and supporting material to explain the broader context of my circumstances. I have recorded a public SOS because I feel trapped, isolated and unable to obtain the assistance I need. I ask that the material already supplied be considered as context for my hardship and vulnerability, while the bank independently examines the specific banking issues within its responsibility.

Please review the existing complaint history before requesting that I repeat information already provided. If something genuinely essential is missing, identify it precisely and explain how I can supply it without reliable telephone, app or NetBank access.

8. Immediate humanitarian hardship

My current circumstances require practical assistance, not simply administrative correspondence.

I have described difficulties obtaining food, medication, medical care, telephone access and reliable access to my own money. I have also reported abuse, neglect and serious concerns about my safety.

I am asking Commonwealth Bank to recognise that inaccessible banking facilities can have consequences far beyond inconvenience. In my circumstances, the inability to communicate with the bank or access appropriate banking services compounds an already precarious situation.

Please tell me what lawful, practical arrangements are available for me to obtain assistance with essential banking needs while the complaint is investigated.

If the bank cannot restore access immediately, please identify what alternative arrangements are available, who has authority to approve them and how I can access those arrangements without relying on the channels that are currently unavailable to me.

9. Actions I require from Commonwealth Bank

Please treat this email as a formal request for urgent escalation and a substantive written response addressing the following matters:

1. **Banking restrictions:** Confirm the current restrictions affecting my banking access and the authority or instructions on which they are based.

2. **Alternative identity verification:** Provide a practical alternative given that I cannot reliably access a telephone, the mobile application or NetBank.
3. **Specialist escalation:** Refer the matter to Cyber Crime or the appropriate specialist team where warranted, and explain how that team can progress the matter using an accessible communication method.
4. **Accountable case management:** Assign a responsible complaint officer or case manager, or explain the available alternative, and provide a workable means of communication.
5. **Bateau Bay branch visits:** Review the history of my repeated visits and identify the complaints, referrals and decisions recorded.
6. **Goulburn branch visit:** Investigate my previous visit to the Goulburn branch, including my recollection that the manager said his hands were tied and could not resolve my complaint.
7. **Historical banking records:** Provide a substantive written response concerning the records and financial transactions involving my former partner and me, including the searches undertaken and reasons for any limits on disclosure.
8. **Reported financial wrongdoing:** Explain the status and outcome of my reported financial concerns, including what matters the bank has examined and what further steps are available.
9. **Staff and security interaction:** Investigate the circumstances in which I recall becoming distressed and being threatened with removal by security, taking into account the events that preceded that interaction.
10. **Complaint history:** Provide a clear account of the status and outcome of my previous complaints, including any unresolved issues and the process for independent review.
11. **Immediate hardship:** Consider the practical assistance available to me while the banking-access complaint is investigated.
12. **Written communication:** Confirm receipt of this complaint and provide a complaint reference and a written response that I can retain as a record.

If Cyber Crime is not the appropriate team to resolve every aspect of this matter, please coordinate the necessary internal referrals and identify the team responsible for each issue. I should not have to navigate inaccessible systems or repeatedly reconstruct the same history to obtain a response.

If the bank considers that an instruction or legal arrangement prevents it from taking a particular action, please identify the nature and scope of that restriction and explain what options remain available. I am seeking clarity and lawful solutions, not an instruction to disregard legal obligations.

10. Final statement

I have extended patience and goodwill throughout this process. I have repeatedly tried to give Commonwealth Bank opportunities to respond to my concerns and assist me in resolving them.

I cannot continue to be sent around in circles while my practical needs remain unmet and my substantive complaints remain unanswered.

I am asking for a human response, meaningful accountability and a practical solution. After more than 45 years as a Commonwealth Bank customer, I should not be left without a workable path to communicate with my bank or obtain clear answers about serious concerns I have raised.

Please do not interpret my distress as a reason to dismiss the substance of my complaint. It is a consequence of the circumstances I am trying to resolve. I ask you to examine the underlying issues independently, document the outcome and communicate your findings in writing.

I have reported circumstances that I regard as deeply harmful and unjust. I have sought assistance from multiple organisations and have repeatedly experienced those efforts as unsuccessful. I need Commonwealth Bank to take responsibility for its own decisions, examine the records within its control and provide an intelligible account of what can and cannot be done.

I am not asking for special treatment. I am asking for fair treatment, a transparent process, access to appropriate banking assistance and a meaningful response to my complaints.

Please stop directing me back to channels I cannot access. Please review the history, investigate the unresolved matters and provide a workable way forward.

I ask Commonwealth Bank to respond with the urgency, care and seriousness this situation requires.

Kind regards,

Dr Richard William McLean
Publicly known as **Dr Barran Dodger**

URGENT — Banking access, financial hardship, unresolved complaints at Bateau Bay and Goulburn, historical banking records and request for specialist escalation

Before sending: Keep the details about Goulburn and the security interaction as your recollection unless you have documents confirming them. This preserves your testimony while clearly asking Commonwealth Bank to investigate its own records.

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